

Rose-Type Comparison Image Field Guide

The eleven rose-type images generated to illustrate scope — three currently in-scope classes and eight excluded lookalikes — with a title, a plain description of what each shows, and the AI-generated placeholder currently standing in for it, so you know at a glance what “good” looks like and what’s still missing.

How to use this in the field

1. Each entry below shows a Tag ID, what the photo needs to demonstrate, how to frame it, and which other type in this set it's most easily confused with.
2. The image on each card is an **AI-generated placeholder**, not a real photo — it's there to show roughly what's needed, not to be matched exactly.
3. When you get a real photo, save it as that entry's Tag ID (e.g. `IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-01.jpg`) and pass it back so it can replace the placeholder in the Sourcing Brief and the Shed.
4. Every entry carries a highlighted note — read those before shooting or sourcing, they flag a real evidence gap or caveat in the research, not a solved distinction.

Source: Ask Pip — Rose-Type Comparison Image Sourcing Brief, v0.1 (28 September 2026), itself drawn from *FRD-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-01* and *FRD-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-LABELS-01*. Every description below is drawn directly from that Brief's sourced findings; nothing here is new content.

1. In-Scope Types

The three classes Ask Pip currently plans to recognise. Height alone will not separate any of the three from one another — flower arrangement is what carries the distinction.

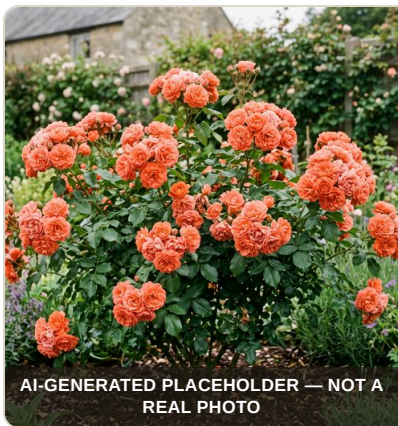


IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-01

1.1 Hybrid Tea (positive example)

- What to show** Flowers borne singly at the top of each stem, not in dense clusters.
- Framing** Whole-bush shot showing several stems and their flower spacing, plus one closer shot of a single stem's flower arrangement.
- Lookalikes** Floribunda (1.2) and Grandiflora (1.3) — height alone does not separate any of the three.

Height overlaps with Floribunda and no source gives a separating threshold. Not useful as a dormant, leafless-plant photo.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-02

1.2 Floribunda (positive example)

- What to show** Flowers borne in dense clusters at the end of each stem.
- Framing** Whole-bush shot capturing several clusters at once, so bloom density per stem-end is visible against the foliage.
- Lookalikes** Hybrid Tea (1.1) and Grandiflora (1.3).

One source (OSU) actually describes Floribunda as the larger plant — height should not be used as a distinguishing cue at all.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-03

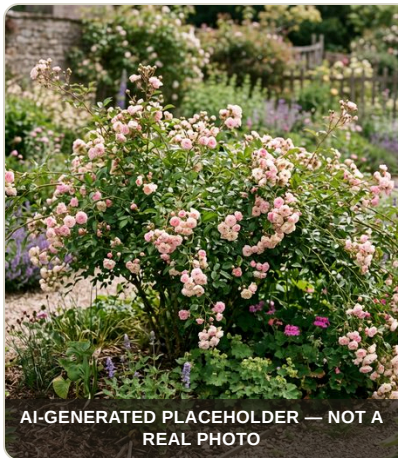
1.3 Grandiflora (in scope, provisional)

- What to show** Hybrid-Tea-shaped flowers borne in small clusters; the tallest habit of the three in-scope classes.
- Framing** Wide shot showing height relative to a fence or neighbouring plant, plus the clustered-but-Hybrid-Tea-form flowers close up.
- Lookalikes** Hybrid Tea (1.1) and Floribunda (1.2).

Standard in US retail but essentially absent from NZ/AU retail and inconsistent in the UK. Grandiflora's own scope status is still an open Founder Decision Point — this image does not settle that.

2. Small and Compact Lookalikes

Sources disagree amongst themselves on where several of these sit relative to one another — no single image here should be presented as a settled boundary.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-04

2.1 Shrub (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Larger, open, spreading or arching form.
- Framing** Wide shot capturing the whole plant's width and arching cane shape, ideally beside an upright bush for contrast.
- Lookalikes** Can be labelled "Rose Bush" at retail even where the retailer's own category places it as Shrub.

The shrub class is explicitly heterogeneous — a "catch-all." One image cannot represent the whole class.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-05

2.2 Patio (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Small, container-scale bush, roughly 30–75 cm.
- Framing** Shown in or near a pot, with a full-size garden bed or upright bush visible for scale contrast.
- Lookalikes** Sometimes filed inside a general "Bush Roses" retail bucket rather than its own category.

Sources disagree what a patio rose is nearest to — miniature, dwarf floribunda, or its own container-rose term. Don't caption it as resembling one class more than another.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-06

2.3 Miniature (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Very small overall size, upper heights around 20–75 cm across sources.
- Framing** A scale reference object (trowel, ruler) included in the frame.
- Lookalikes** Miniflora (2.4) — several sources combine the two under the same figures.

Present alongside a Miniflora image, not in isolation, given the combined-figures caveat above.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-07

2.4 Miniflora (excluded lookalike)

What to show	Bloom and foliage size distinctly between Miniature and Floribunda.
Framing	Ideally a three-way comparison alongside Miniature and Floribunda images, since this type is defined entirely by being “in between.”
Lookalikes	Miniature (2.3) and Floribunda (1.2).

This distinction rests on bloom/foilage size, not observable on a dormant, leafless plant — a winter photo of this type is not useful for recognition regardless of framing.

3. Growth-Habit Lookalikes

Distinctive habits when the feature is visible — but the underlying evidence has a real, unresolved gap for two of the three.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-08

3.1 Groundcover (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Low, wide-spreading habit, generally under 50 cm tall but spreading over a metre, forming a dense mat or mound.
- Framing** Elevated or angled shot capturing the plant's width, not a straight-on view that could read as a low bush.
- Lookalikes** The word “bush” is sometimes wrongly applied to this type at general retailers.

Appearance evidence rests substantially on one marketer's description — flag as such, not as a settled visual rule.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-09

3.2 Climbing, including climbing sports (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Long canes trained on or reaching toward a support, with flowers on shorter lateral side-shoots rather than the main canes.
- Framing** Shot including the support structure (trellis, arch, fence), plus a closer shot of flowers on the laterals.
- Lookalikes** None of the other ten types — the support structure and trained habit are distinctive.

No source addresses whether a climbing sport of an in-scope cultivar ever reverts to bush form — this image cannot settle that.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-10

3.3 Standard (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Single tall, bare, grafted stem topped with a rounded crown of foliage and flowers — the “lollipop” silhouette.
- Framing** Full-height shot from ground level to crown — the bare stem is the entire distinguishing feature.
- Lookalikes** None of the other ten types — the bare stem is unambiguous when visible.

No source addresses how an older standard with regrowth below the graft should be recognised — this young, clean example is not representative of all standards.

4. Historic and Species Types

The most evidence-thin category in either dossier for visual recognition — defined by lineage and flowering habit, not a plant-form rule a photograph can show.



IMG-BUSHROSE-ROSETYPE-11

4.1 Old Garden / species (excluded lookalike)

- What to show** Informal, historic-variety flower form — commonly many-petalled and cupped, or single-petalled with 4–8 petals.
- Framing** A caption naming the specific historic class shown (Alba, Bourbon, Damask, Gallica, etc.) is more useful than the photo alone.
- Lookalikes** Shrub (2.1) — both can present as informal, arching bushes.

No source gives a plant-form rule for this class, only historical and flowering-season facts. A single representative photo risks implying a visual consistency the evidence does not support.